universities, the educational institutions and the religious organisations. The main purpose of their policy would be to foment pro-Islamic, proPakistani feelings and encourage antiIndian and anti-Hindu feelings. In due course, if the events in Bangladesh move in a direction favourable to them, Pakistan may promote the idea of a confederation between the two countries.

According to Krishna, the R&AW officers were more worried about Pakistan's plan to destabilise India's east and north-eastern regions working from Bangladesh, which is geographically close to India's West Bengal, the troubled tribal areas of the northeast, and also Nepal, Bhutan and Sikkim. The draft said:

Zulfikar Ali Bhutto went so far as to say that this region has the potential of developing into another Vietnam. It is, therefore, likely that Pakistan will provide support and encouragement to the Nagas and Mizos as also to the Naxalites. Pakistan may also seek to foment disaffection against India among the Nepalese and try to create complications in our relationship with Nepal and Bhutan. Pakistan has—in the past— claimed to be the protector of the Muslims in India. Indeed, this claim is implicit in the two-nation theory. As such, once Pakistan re-establishes its presence in Bangladesh, they would extend the network of their operations to the minority community in Bengal, Bihar, Tripura and Assam.

Internal Insecurity

India feared that Bangladesh was likely to become extremely vulnerable to foreign manipulations and pressures mainly from the USA and reactionary oil rich Arab states, compromising the idea of secularism espoused by Mujib. In consequence, the